

Figure 3.2 Passengers experience a backward push due to inertia of rest

continue in the state of rest, while the bus moves forward. This appears as a backward push as shown in Figure 3.2. *The inability of an object to change its state of rest is called inertia of rest.*

2. **Inertia of motion:** When the bus is in motion, and if the brake is applied suddenly, passengers move forward and hit against the front seat. In this case, the bus comes to a stop, while the body (of a passenger) continues to move forward due to the property of inertia as shown in Figure 3.3. *The inability of an object to change its state of uniform speed (constant speed) on its own is called inertia of motion.*
3. **Inertia of direction:** When a stone attached to a string is in whirling motion, and if the string is cut suddenly, the stone will not continue to move in circular motion but moves tangential to the circle as illustrated in Figure 3.4. This is because the body cannot change its direction of motion without any force acting on it. *The inability of an object to change its direction of motion on its own is called inertia of direction.*



Figure 3.3 Passengers experience a forward push due to inertia of motion

When we say that an object is at rest or in motion with constant velocity, it has a meaning only if it is specified with respect to some reference frames. In physics, any motion has to be stated with respect to a reference frame. It is to be noted that Newton's first law is valid only in certain special reference frames called inertial frames. In fact, Newton's first law defines an inertial frame.

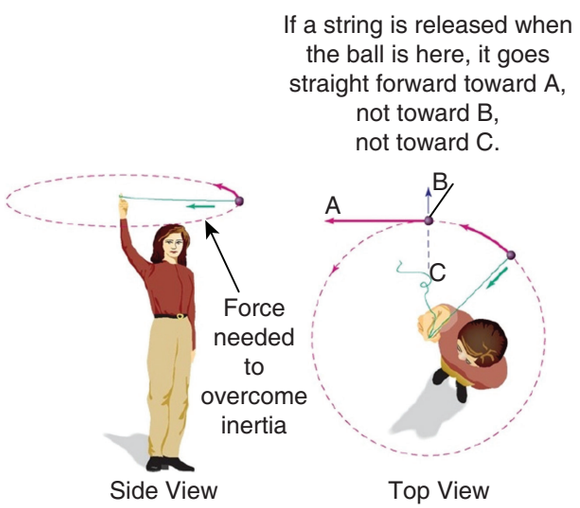


Figure 3.4 A stone moves tangential to circle due to inertia of direction

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